

Types of Networks

Learning Objectives

- Differentiate between LAN, MAN, and WAN
- Give examples of each network type from daily life
- Understand the range and speed differences between network types

Engage (5-7 minutes)

Think about three things: your classroom LAN cable connecting all computers, the cable TV network covering your whole town, and the internet connecting India to the world. These are like local, city-wide, and worldwide roads for data—each covering a different distance.

Explore (10-12 minutes)

Match these network types to their coverage: LAN, MAN, WAN. Draw three circles representing small, medium, and large areas and label each with the correct network type. Discuss with a partner why your school likely uses a LAN.

Explain (10-12 minutes)

LAN (Local Area Network) connects computers in a small area like a school or office building. MAN (Metropolitan Area Network) covers a city or large campus, like a cable TV network. WAN (Wide Area Network) spans countries and continents—the internet is the largest WAN in the world.

Elaborate (8-10 minutes)

Consider a village panchayat setup. If five computers in the panchayat office share a printer, that is a LAN. If the panchayat office connects to the block office ten kilometers away, that is a MAN. If the block office connects to the state capital, that is a WAN. Which type would connect your school to the district education office?

Evaluate (5-8 minutes)

Exit ticket: Write the full form of LAN, MAN, and WAN. Then give one real-life example of each. If you finish early, explain why a WAN is slower than a LAN.